



SUBSPACE LATTICE

Command the Fleet. Control the Lattice.

FLEET TACTICS · SIGNAL WARFARE · SOVEREIGN SPACE

Every ship is a weapon.

Every signal redraws the battlefield.

THE BATTLE FOR THE LATTICE

You do not conquer space.

You make it yours.

Your fleet is small, and every move changes what it can see, where it can strike, and which systems still work. Push too far and your relay breaks. Hold back and the opposing net claims the sector. Victory belongs to the commander who turns position into pressure—and pressure into one decisive opening.

ESTABLISH THE SIGNAL

Keep your Escorts linked and project Sovereign Space from the Command Hub. Your Formation is your reach—and your lifeline.

TURN SPACE INTO A WEAPON

Catch enemy ships inside your net to Target Lock their systems. Shape firing lanes for Beams and leave gaps only you can exploit.

FORCE THE FINAL MOVE

Strike the enemy Hub—or integrate the sector until hiding is no longer possible. The lattice makes every stalemate temporary.

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Space isn't empty — it's unclaimed. Outside your Sensor Net, a Beam has nothing to lock a shot along and might as well be unarmed. Cross into the enemy's glow and the problem reverses: their net has you now, Target Locked to a single crawling step. Even the seams where both nets bleed together — Contested Space — answer to neither side. Out here, you don't just sail through a sector — you weave the Subspace Lattice through it, thread by thread, and make it yours.

You aren't just commanding a fleet in a standard dogfight; you are leading a high-stakes tactical conquest inside a deadly, electromagnetic dead zone.

Heavy particle weapons can't fire into unmapped space, and a Beam built to ride warp lanes finds none to ride out here — cut off from every net, it's a gun with nothing to aim through. Your fleet's survival depends on maintaining a synchronized **Subspace Lattice**, a living signal network anchored to your flagship and carried outward, relay by relay, by the only hulls built to take the dark on the chin: your Escorts. Every move you make isn't just positioning a ship; it's deploying high-powered relay nodes, cutting off an opponent's power grid, and trapping enemy vessels in your tactical web.

Your goal is absolute mission completion: eliminate the opposing commander in a ruthless Surgical Strike, or saturate the sector in Sovereign Space until their fleet's grid collapses into total blackout. Dig in and commit to neither, and the standoff can drag on indefinitely — which is exactly what the sector clock exists to end.

Collapse at Sector 11

Deep within contested territory lies Sector 11 — a strategic gateway shattered decades ago when a stellar core imploded. Neither faction can afford to cede control, and nothing beyond your own Hub's halo is mapped when you arrive.

When opposing task forces drop into Sector 11, sensors read dark past the edge of your own formation. A Beam pushed out ahead of that glow is carrying a lance with no lane to fire down — no lock, no slide, no shot. Your Escorts feel none of it; they were never built to ride the Lattice, only to lay it, and it's their job to plod forward relay-hop by relay-hop into ground nobody's mapped yet. As armadas advance, network fields expand and collide. Where those signals clash, **Contested Space** sparks — an electronic warfare dead zone where tactical dominance is completely neutralized.

Sector Anomaly

Coordinates `(5,5)` mark the exact center of the arena, occupied entirely by **Anomalous Core** (the Gravity Well).

- A superdense, collapsed singularity left behind from the star's demise, its gravitational tear is so severe that matter, kinetic ordnance, and subspace signals are swallowed whole.
- Acting as an impenetrable pillar in the middle of the void, this singularity splits the battlefield into two distinct choke points. Commanders cannot fire or warp through the Anomaly—forcing an early strategic choice between pressing down the left flank or anchoring the right flank to box in opposing forces.

Fleet Assets

Every vessel on your grid serves a vital purpose within the broader signal architecture:

-  **Command Hub (Flagship):** The Command Hub is the beating heart and sovereign brain of the fleet. Deep within the unmapped dark, it acts as the primary power anchor, projecting the vital 3-square halo of **Sovereign Space** that keeps the armada alive. Every strategic calculation, firing solution, and subspace telemetry feed flows through its heavily armored hull. It is the ultimate prize and the single point of failure—if the flagship's hull is breached, the surrounding network instantly collapses into the void, and the mission is lost.
 - » **Hang / Refusing the hang** → In the chaotic geometry of the Lattice, leaving the flagship exposed to a direct, immediate firing solution is known as a “Hang.” When the Hub's threat-detection systems blare, it means an enemy strike is already spooling up. A commander cannot simply ignore this to order an attack elsewhere; survival protocols demand you immediately “refuse the hang.” Maneuvering the flagship to safety or neutralizing the immediate threat takes absolute, overriding priority.
 - » **Command Overload / EMP** → The flagship's reactor is powerful enough to be weaponized even while the escort network remains intact. By temporarily routing all navigational power into the central capacitors, the Hub can unleash a localized electromagnetic pulse. Executing this maneuver requires the flagship's total operational focus for the cycle. Any enemy vessels caught in the resulting shock-wave suffer violent power surges, instantly seizing their engine coils and stranding them in the dark. If you manage to catch every remaining enemy ship in this snare—whether a clustered fleet or a lone, desperate flagship—they are left with zero viable escape vectors. Their entire grid collapses into a catastrophic Lock-out, freezing their fleet solid and winning you the sector without firing a single shot.

- » **Terminal Overclock / EMP** → When a fleet is annihilated and only the flagships remain in the dark, standard combat doctrine is abandoned. As the final moments of the standoff tick away, command unlocks authorization for a lethal contingency. Under normal operation, a Command Hub safely vents its massive excess radiation through the Escort relay network. When a Hub initiates a Terminal Overclock, those vents seal tight, creating a closed-loop cascade in the main drive. The ship's reactor enters a state of thermal runaway, packing raw, unstable energy denser and denser by the minute. You can hold the charge to guarantee a wider hit, but you are slowly boiling your own ship alive to do it. The terror of this maneuver is that it is entirely visible. Both commanders can read the ambient radiation spiking on their remaining sensors. For a captain trying to flee, the coward's strategy of endlessly kiting the blast radius only guarantees one outcome: when the containment field finally drops, the shockwave will have grown large enough to blanket the entire sector. There is nowhere left to hide.
-  **Escorts (Subspace Repeaters):** Mobile subspace repeaters engineered for network range rather than armor, and hardy enough to push into unmapped dark with no signal of their own to lean on. On their own, their signal coverage is limited, but when daisy-chained back to the Hub within two light-seconds, they push active network coverage directly to the front lines. Severing an Escort line leaves forward units dark.
- »  **Initiative Relay (Vanguard Node):** One extra Escort, granted only to whichever commander commits to the sector first, as compensation for revealing their hand early. Deployed forward during initial drop-in, this lead Escort establishes an early foothold, giving its commander immediate midboard leverage to secure opening grid dominance.
-  **Beams (Lattice Dreadnoughts):** Massive dreadnoughts armed with long-range particle lances. Their own thrusters can't carry them into a fight — instead, these warships ride the energized channels of your active network, sliding across light-years in a single maneuver as long as they stay inside active Sensor Net boundaries. Strand one outside every net, and its guns are just dead weight.
- »  **Refractor (Slipstream Cutter):** Optional wing dreadnought. Where a Beam relies on the orthogonal channels of your network, the Refractor exploits the diagonal subspace seams of Sovereign Space. It can slice past the Anomaly's blocked axes, opening firing vectors a Beam could never reach. Like all heavy artillery, it requires an active telemetry link; strand it outside your glow, and its engines go dead.
- »  **Carrier (Aegis Vanguard):** Optional capital hull that combines orthogonal and diagonal routing into absolute omni-directional grid control. However, this massive dreadnought is bound to a strict Hub-anchor. To execute a full subspace slide, it must draw power directly from the Command Hub's natural radiation halo at the start of its maneuver. Drift beyond that tether, and its capacitors starve, reducing it to a crawl until it re-enters the flagship's power grid.

-  **Infiltrators (Phase Runners):** Tactical strike craft equipped with localized folding drives, engineered to jump across the board independent of any signal and eliminate exposed targets. However, entering hostile network space immediately triggers a sensor Target Lock on their engine coils, stranding them without warp capabilities.

Securing the Sector

Two paths lead to total victory — and a third, grimmer one that can end the mission even when neither commander is chasing it:

1. Surgical Strike (Decapitation):

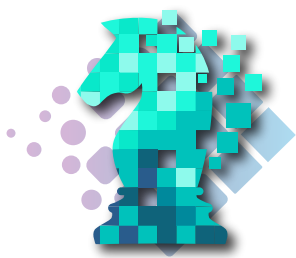
- *Flank the relay lines, clear a firing lane for your long-range Beams, and strike the opposing Command Hub. Once the flagship is destroyed, their fleet goes dark. Mission accomplished.*

2. Sector Integration (Total Dominance):

- *If an opponent digs in behind heavy shields, force a system lockout. Expand your signal chains until Sovereign Space controls 45% of the sector. Hold that ground once the sector clock arms, and their systems overload into an emergency fleet shutdown.*

3. Lockout (Frozen):

- *Leave an opponent with no legal move anywhere on the grid and their fleet freezes solid — a loss for them, not a stalemate. Bodies alone almost never finish this against a live Hub. Commanders who anchor the flagship and keep charging **Command Overload** can dump an EMP into the enemy formation, seize their engines for a reply, and force Lockout when every remaining ship sits in the blast.*



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